Lee-Ann Vidal-Covas | PhD

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Education

2025 **Ph.D.**, *Boston University*, Linguistics
Dissertation: *Covariation & salience in linguistic contact: a sociophonetic study of liquid variation in Boston Spanish*
Committee: Daniel G. Erker (Chair), Neil J. Myler & Kate Lynn Lindsey

2021 **M.A.**, *Boston University*, Linguistics

2013 **M.A.**, *Louisiana State University*, Hispanic Studies/Spanish Linguistics
Thesis: *El uso variable de los pronombres sujetos en el castellano puertorriqueño hablado en Luisiana y Puerto Rico*
Committee: Rafael Orozco, Jeremy King & Andrea Morris

2011 **B.A.**, *Louisiana State University*, Hispanic Studies and Literatures

2020 **The New York - St. Petersburg Institute of Linguistics, Cognition, and Culture**, Coursework in writing systems and phonology, morphology, experimental linguistics & syntax

Publications

Refereed Journal Articles

2024 Erker, Daniel G. & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Variation, Contact, and Change in Boston Spanish: How social meaning shapes stylistic practice and bilingual optimization. *Studies in Hispanic and Lusophone Linguistics*, 17(2), 223–249. [DOI]

Refereed Proceedings

2023 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** ¿Va primero el verbo? or ¿El sujeto va primero?: Subject-verb order in Latin American Spanish. *Proceedings of the Linguistic Society of America*, 8(1), Article 5542, pp. 1–17. [DOI]

2014 Orozco, Rafael; Méndez Vallejo, Catalina; & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Los efectos condicionantes del verbo en el uso variable de los pronombres personales de sujeto. *Actas del XVII Congreso Internacional de la Asociación de Lingüística y Filología de la América Latina*, pp. 1–17.

Contributions to Edited Volumes (invited)

2022 Erker, Daniel G. & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** What we say when we say nothing at all: Clues to contact-induced language change in Spanish conversational pause-fillers. *Estudios del Observatorio / Observatorio Studies*, 80, pp. 1–29.

Erker, Daniel G. & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Qué decimos cuando no decimos nada: Claves del cambio lingüístico inducido por contacto en las pausas llenas del español conversacional. *Estudios del Observatorio / Observatorio Studies*, 80, pp. 1–31.

Edited Volumes

2021 Dionne, Danielle & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** (Eds). Proceedings of the 45th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development. Somerville, MA, Cascadilla Press.

Other Publications

2013 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** El uso variable de los pronombres sujetos en el castellano puertorriqueño hablado en Luisiana y Puerto Rico. *LSU Master's Theses*, 3876. [DOI]

Presentations

Refereed Papers

2024 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** How Salience Influences Dialectal Persistence and Covariation: Insights from Boston's Spanish-Speaking Community, *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 52*, Miami, FL, Nov 7th – 9th.

Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M. Investigating Salience and Ideologies in Greater Boston: a Sociophonetic Analysis of Liquid Variation, *International Symposium on Language Ideologies and Attitudes*, Palma de Mallorca, Spain, October 17th – 19th.

Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M. Riding the Waves of Salience: Exploring Spanish Liquid Variation among Boston Spanish speakers, *LSA 2024*, NYC, New York, January 4th – 7th.

2023 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Making a Splash: The Salience of Liquid Variation among Boston Spanish speakers, *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 51*, NYC, New York, October 13th – 15th.

2014 Orozco, Rafael; Méndez Vallejo, Catalina; & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** The Verb as a Predictor of Variable Pronominal Use in Spanish, *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 43*, Chicago, Illinois, October 23rd – 26th.

Orozco, Rafael; Méndez Vallejo, Catalina; & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Los efectos condicionantes del verbo en el uso variable de los pronombres personales de sujeto, *The Association of Linguistics and Philology Latin America Conference*, Paraiba, João Pessoa, Brazil, July 14th – 19th.

Orozco, R., Méndez Vallejo, Catalina, & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Verb-related Constraints on Variable Pronominal Use: Do we have all the Answers?, *7th International Workshop on Spanish Sociolinguistics*, Madison, Wisconsin, April 3rd – 5th.

Orozco, Rafael; Méndez Vallejo, Catalina; & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** The Effects of Verb Semantics on Pronominal Expression: A Preliminary Study, *XXIX Biennial Louisiana Conference on Hispanic Languages & Literatures*, Baton Rouge, Louisiana, Feb 27th - March 1st.

Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M. El uso variable de los pronombres sujetos en el castellano puertorriqueño hablado en Luisiana y Puerto Rico, *XXIX Biennial Louisiana Conference on Hispanic Languages & Literatures*, Baton Rouge, LA, Feb 27th – March 1st.

2013 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Variable use of subject pronouns in the Spanish in Louisiana, *2nd Graduate Symposium Universidad de Puerto Rico*, Río Piedras, Puerto Rico, April.

Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M. & Linder, Cali. Variable use of subject pronouns in Spanish, *Southeastern Conference on Linguistics LXXX*, Spartanburg, South Carolina, April 4th – 6th.

Invited Talks

2024 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Salient Features, Strong Identities: Social Meaning and Stylistic Choices in Boston Spanish, *World Languages, Literatures & Cultures Department - Louisiana State University*, New Orleans, LA, Dec 3rd.

2023 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Making a Splash: The Salience of Liquid Variation among Boston Spanish speakers, *Linguistics Program - Northeastern University*, Boston, MA, March 23rd.

2020 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Guest Lecture: English/Spanish Contrastive Phonology & Filled Pauses, *Intro to Sounds - Boston University*, Boston, MA, October 15th.

2017 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Teaching Foreign Language in the 21st Century Classroom, *Louisiana Education Technology Consortium*, Baton Rouge, LA, March.

Refereed Posters

2023 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** ¿Va primero el verbo OR El sujeto va primero?: Subject-Verb order in Latin American Spanish, *LSA 2023*, Denver, CO, January 5th– 8th.

2021 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Filled pauses as a site of language contact among Spanish-speaking Bostonians, *LSA 2021*, Virtual, January 9th.

Campus/Departmental Talks

2025 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Covariation & salience in linguistic contact: a sociophonetic study of liquid variation in Boston Spanish, *Dissertation Defense - Boston University*, Boston, MA, April 7th.

2023 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Making a Splash: The Salience of Liquid Variation among Boston Spanish speakers, *Graduate Research Forum - Boston University*, Boston, MA, March 20th.

2020 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Filled pauses as a site of language contact among Spanish-speaking Bostonians, *Graduate Research Forum - Boston University*, Virtual, December 2nd.

2013 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** El uso variable de los pronombres sujetos en el castellano puertorriqueño hablado en Luisiana y Puerto Rico, *LSU Spanish Roundtable*, Baton Rouge, LA, October.

Honors and Awards

2019 **Student-Nominated Teaching Appreciation Award**, *St. Joseph's Academy, Baton Rouge*, Student-nominated recognition acknowledging positive academic and personal impact

2013 **Graduate Presentation Award**, *2nd Graduate Symposium*, Universidad de Puerto Rico–Río Piedras, Awarded for outstanding conference presentation (USD 200)

Grants and Fellowships

Fellowships and Research Grants

2018 – 2024 **Graduate Student Fellowship**, *Boston University GRS & Office of the Provost*, Fall 2023, Spring 2024

Graduate Student Fellowship, *Boston University Linguistics Department*, Spring 2019, Spring 2022, Fall 2022, Spring 2023

Research Fellowship, *Boston University Linguistics Dept*, Sum 2019, Fall 2019, Sum 2020, Fall 2020, Spring 2021, Fall 2021

Teaching Fellowship, *Boston University Linguistics Department*, Fall 2018, Spring 2020

Graduate Research Grant, *Boston University Linguistics Department*, Spring 2021, USD 1,000

2016 – 2017 **21st Century Classroom Research Grant**, *Saint Joseph's Academy*, USD 10,000

2012 – 2013 **Teaching Fellowship**, *Louisiana State University Foreign Languages & Literatures Department*, Spring 2012, Sum 2012, Fall 2012, Spring 2013, Sum 2013, Fall 2013

Conference Travel and Registration Awards

2023 – 2024 **Conference Travel Grants**, *Boston University Linguistics Department & Graduate Student Organization*, supported research dissemination at national and international conferences, Total awarded: USD ≈ 4,200

2024 **Student Registration Award**, *IDEOLING Organizing Committee*, Fundació Universitat Empresa de les Illes Balears, EUR 100

2021 **LSA Registration Award**, Committee on Ethnic Diversity in Linguistics, Linguistic Society of America

2013 **Conference Travel Grants**, *Louisiana State University*, supported research dissemination at national and international conferences, Total awarded: USD ≈ 1,500

Research Experience

Graduate Student Researcher

2021 – 2025 **Dissertation**
Covariation & Salience in Linguistic Contact: A Sociophonetic Study of Liquid Variation in Spanish in Boston
Committee: Daniel G. Erker (Chair), Neil J. Myler & Kate Lynn Lindsey

2020 – 2021 **2nd Ph.D. Qualifying Paper**
Subject-Verb Order in Latin American Spanish
Committee: Neil J. Myler (1st Reader), Daniel G. Erker, & Paul Hagstrom

2019 – 2020 **1st Ph.D. Qualifying Paper**
Filled Pauses as a site of dialectal and language contact among Spanish-speaking Bostonians
Committee: Daniel G. Erker (1st Reader), Neil J. Myler, & Jon Barnes

2011 – 2013 **M.A. Thesis**
El uso variable de los pronombres sujetos en el castellano puertorriqueño hablado en Luisiana y Puerto Rico
Committee: Rafael Orozco (Chair), Jeremy King, & Andrea Morris

Research Assistanships

2018 – 2025 **Sociolinguistics Lab**, *Spanish in Boston Project*, PI: Daniel G. Erker

2020 – 2021 **Structures of Under-researched Languages Lab**, *The Mirror Principle Violations Project*, PI: Neil Myler

Linguistic Fieldwork

2012 – 2013 **Puerto Rican Spanish**, in Puerto Rico and Louisiana

Teaching Experience

Boston University

2026 **Quantitative Methods in Linguistics**, *(GRS LX 795, graduate)*, Fall 2026
Course Facilitator for Daniel G. Erker

2018 – 2021 **Language and Music**, *(CAS LX 120)*, Fall 2021
Grader for Daniel G. Erker

Introduction to Sound Systems, *(CAS LX 301/601)*, Fall 2020
Course Assistant for Kate Lynn Lindsey

Say what? Accents, Dialects, and Society, *(CAS LX 110)*, Fall 2018, Spring 2020
Teaching Fellow for Neil J. Myler

Academy of the Sacred Heart (Middle School)

2017 – 2018 **Introductory Spanish & Basic Technology**
Instructor of Record

Saint Joseph's Academy (High School)

2014 – 2017 **Elementary Spanish I & II; Computer & Software Orientation**
Instructor of Record

Louisiana State University

2012 – 2013 **Elementary Spanish I & II**, *Span 1101 & 1102*
Instructor of Record

Service

To the Department

2021 – 2022 **Graduate Student Organizer**, *Linguistics Department Colloquium Series*, Boston University

2021 **Panelist**, *Virtual Open House for MA/PhD Linguistics Programs*, Boston University, December 13th

2020 **Panelist**, *Panel on PhD Applications*, Boston University, November 4th

2019 **Lab Manager**, *Sociolinguistics Lab*, Boston University

To the Discipline: Editorial and Review Work

2026 – **3 journal manuscript reviews** for: *Studies in Hispanic and Lusophone Linguistics, Asia-Pacific Language Variation*

To the Discipline: Committee

2020 **Co-Organizer**, *45th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*
Sponsorship Chair, *45th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*

2019 **Volunteer Chair**, *44th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*

To the Discipline: Other Work

2021 **Volunteer**, *95th Annual Meeting Linguistic Society of America (LSA2021)*

2018 **Volunteer**, *43rd Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*, Boston University

2014 **Volunteer**, *XXIX Biennial Louisiana Conference on Hispanic Languages & Literatures*, LSU

2013 **Volunteer**, *LXXX SouthEastern Conference on Linguistics (SECOL)*, Spartanburg, SC

2012 **Volunteer**, *XXVIII Biennial Louisiana Conference on Hispanic Languages & Literatures*, LSU

Other Service

2014 – 2017 **Co-Organizer**, *Louisiana Association of High School Spanish Clubs' Annual Conference*

Languages

Native English, Spanish
Elementary Brazilian Portuguese
Fieldwork Indonesian, West Greenlandic, Wichita, Yagua, Zulu

Technology

R
VSCode
Git/GitHub
Python
Bash/Terminal
LaTeX
HTML
regex

Citizenship

Dual Citizenship American & Spanish